



Aldyr Schlee
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»» FIFA WORLD CUP SPECIAL
SPOTLIGHT

When Brazil turned YELLOW

How a national heartbreak, a design contest and an unlikely Uruguay supporter gave Brazil its **iconic football jersey.**

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Imagine the most iconic football jersey of all time. Not a particular design, but a colour combination. There is a good chance you thought of Brazil's home kit.

The bright yellow shirt and sharp blue shorts, accented by touches of green and white, carry a certain vibrancy, mirroring the attacking flair that has long defined the five-time World Cup champion.

But for the first half of the 20th century, Brazil did not play in those colours.

It is almost inconceivable now, but across the first four editions of the FIFA World Cup, the South American giant wore an almost

entirely white kit with blue trim.

The decision to switch to the current yellow-blue design was prompted by a 'tragedy' that haunted Brazil for decades. And the man who created it was not even a supporter of the Brazilian national team.

In the 1950 World Cup, the first to be hosted by Brazil, expectations for the home team were sky high.

Even without being at its fluent best, Brazil cruised through most of its campaign. It topped the opening group stage before winning its first two matches in the final group phase.

Eternal legacy: Uruguayan and Brazilian players observe a minute's silence in honour of Aldyr Schlee (above) ahead of their international friendly, a day after his death. AFP

